

ther angry at the dev “blatantly” ripping off the old classic nor are we giving it a pass. Just hear us out.

We are not going to deny the fact that some elements in the game really have been copied one-to-one from Quake. Firstly, although it is a bit subjective, the overall colour palette and the environment the game is set in - the eerie brown filter - has been copied from Quake. Another small but really noticeable thing that has been copied is the hit/kill animations in the game. You see, whenever you fire a bullet and it hits something, a group/cluster



of white dots appear on the place where the bullet hit. If you have ever played Quake, you know for a fact that those dots come from there. In Quake, if you keep shooting your enemy even after it dies, a very gorey animation plays where the enemy's body blasts into pieces with blood splattering all around. Well, the exact same thing has been ported over here. The game's start screen and the level-end screen, both have been copied over from Quake.



There are a lot of things that the dev has copied from Quake but we are ready to forgive most of them. Why? Well, because it adds to the overall experience of the game.

Sound

Unfortunately, this is the only area where the game lacks heavily. The soundtrack for the game is practi-



cally non-existent. Before the soundtrack, let's talk about guns first. Honestly, even the gunshots leave something to be desired. They aren't as bad as the soundtrack but something is miss-

ing from them and that is noticeable everytime you will fire a gun. We think that the gunshots are too saturated around the mids and hence the lows don't get a chance to shine through. All a gunshot needs in this game is a little extra thump to it and we think it would be good to go.

Now, coming to the soundtrack for the game, as we mentioned

earlier, it is practically non-existent. Throughout the course of the game, there is no concept of background music or assistive music. It's just the player, his footsteps and his gunshots. We get it that sometimes, it is needed to increase the “horror” factor but here, it just does not fit.

Even though the game is in early access, we'd still advise the dev to work on the music.

Conclusion

Every game has its own strengths and weaknesses. What makes a game stand apart from the crowd is its ability to hide its weaknesses and showcase its strengths in such a way that the user has very little to no time to think about the weaknesses at all.

Similarly, HROT has its own set of strengths and weaknesses but the good part here is that its strength (gameplay and action) almost always overpowers its weakness (sound).

All in all, if you're looking to pass some time and solve some puzzles, this game might just be the one for you. It has a good balance of difficulty and action which is sure to give you jumpscare sometimes or give you frustration just because you cannot find the exit. Also, if you like reading about Russian and Soviet lore then you too should play this game. Even though the fights and the enemies might not be realistic but the place in which it is set in sure is and you'll see some pretty interesting stuff in the game. If you happen to be a fan of Quake like us and you play this game, be sure to email us about your thoughts and opinions regarding the game to feedback@digit.in *



MOAR!

DEVELOPER

Spytihnëv

PUBLISHER

Spytihnëv

PLATFORMS

Microsoft Windows

PLAYED ON

Microsoft Windows

PRICE

₹396

(Steam)